

type and includes data values and methods. The values stored in the properties are mainly the primitive values which may be numbers, strings or Boolean values.

Various built-in classes are present in Flash ActionScript. The most common built-in classes that are found include Number, Boolean and the String classes which mainly represent primitive values. Other built-in classes such as the Array, Math and XML classes define complex objects which form part of the ECMAScript standard. However in ActionScript 3.0, a new concept of untyped variables was introduced which can be defined in the following two ways:

```
var someObj:*;  
var someObj;
```

A unique feature of the untyped variable which makes it different from the typed one is that the untyped variable has the capacity of holding special values that are undefined. Classes can also be defined by using the class keyword while the class properties can be declared in three ways – i.e. by using the constant keyword for declaring constants, var for declaring variables and get and set methods for defining getter and setter methods. On the other hand, an instance of a class can also be created with the help of a new operator. This can be demonstrated with the following code.

```
var myBirth:Date = new Date();
```

2.6 Packages

In Flash Action Scripting, packages play a pivotal role; these are implemented along with namespaces but are not synonymous with them. While declaring a package a special type of namespace is implicitly created that is only known at compile time. The following code uses the package directive to create a simple package having one class.